

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Is that a UFO?



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about science, exploration, beliefs and opinions.
- I can say that one situation is dependent on another situation.
- I can talk about two actions together.

Ask your partner:

- When you hear accounts of UFO sightings, do you believe them? Why or why not?
- What are the chances of beings from another planet visiting Earth?





Let's Explore!

He woke up in a **pasture***!

* "Pasture" is another word for meadow or grazing land.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

He remembered to close the door before he went out to look at the bright object that was in the meadow. He does not remember leaving the yard or anything at all until the next day when he woke up five miles from home in a similar pasture. If it hadn't been for the for people who helped him, he would be sitting there in a daze. I work at the UFO Center Hotline. If you have seen an UFO I recommend calling us. We advise callers to tell us exactly what happened. I also recommend everyone to write down everything before they call. We advise having privacy when you call as well.

We don't forbid you to go to the press. However, we want to say some can't bear to read what's written. If it weren't for overzealous reporters making fun of stories, more people wouldn't be worrying about telling them. Were it not for our organization, sightings would not be organized into a database. Of course, I regret to say that not all sightings are taken seriously. Were it not for us, the authorities would be fielding a lot of calls from citizens. The government has already invested millions of dollars in research on extraterrestrial life. They may regret me telling you this, but it's true.

Let me go on to say that we help many people over the trauma they sometimes feel when they have UFO sightings. People hate feeling distressed. Had it not been for us, many could end up in hospitals or psychiatric facilities. Some dread talking about their experiences. Others can't stop talking about them. But for us being here, they would still be carrying around their shock and fear. I love my job here at the UFO call center.





Let's Practice!

UFOs are very mysterious, but really exciting!

Instructions: Select the correct answer.

1. _____ reporters tend to make fun of stories.
 - overzealot
 - overjoyed
 - overzealous
 - zealous
2. I saw him sitting there in a _____.
 - days
 - daze
 - daisy
 - dazzle
3. However, we want to say some _____ to read what's written.
 - can't bare
 - can't barren
 - can bear
 - can't bear
4. We advise having _____ when you call as well.
 - privacy
 - private
 - privy
 - piracy
5. We don't _____ you to go to the press.
 - forbade
 - forbidden
 - forbid
 - forbids



Let's Practice!

If you see a UFO, should you stop to take a photo?

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Match the two halves to correctly complete each sentence. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. He remembered to close the door before he went out | a. tell us exactly what happened. |
| 2. We advise callers to | b. go to the press. |
| 3. I also recommend that everyone | c. write down everything before they call. |
| 4. We don't forbid you to | d. say that not all sightings are taken seriously. |
| 5. Of course, I regret to | e. to look at the bright object that was in the meadow. |





Extension Activity

Watch an episode of The X Files.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Watch an episode of The X Files, like Conduit or another one dealing with UFO sightings.
- How is the episode set up to make you believe that UFO sightings are commonplace?
- What do the characters have to say about UFOs?
- Take down as many quotes as you can from the episode.
- Beside each quote, write down your response to it.
- Read your quotes to a partner or group.
- Explain your thoughts on them and invite other ideas to discuss.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch an episode of The X Files.

☐ ☐

I take down quotes about sightings from the episode.

☐ ☐

I write down my responses to the quotes.

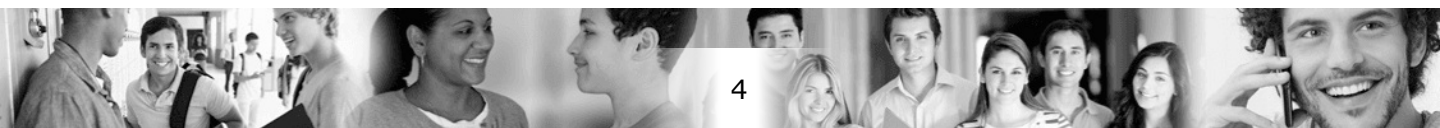
☐ ☐

I share my quotes with a partner or group and discuss them.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- meadow** (noun): an area with grass, flowers and other wild plants in it
e.g. He remembered to close the door before he went out to look at the bright object that was in the meadow.
- daze** (noun): unable to think clearly
e.g. If it hadn't been for the people who helped him, he would sitting there in a daze.
- privacy** (noun): the state of being alone
e.g. We advise having privacy when you call as well.
- to forbid** (verb): to not allow
e.g. We don't forbid you to go to the press.
- can't bear to** (expression): cannot tolerate or endure
e.g. However, we want to say some can't bear to read what's written.
- overzealous** (adjective): too enthusiastic or eager
e.g. If it weren't for overzealous reporters making fun of stories, more people wouldn't be worrying about telling them.
- database** (noun): organized data stored on a computer
e.g. Were it not for our organization, sightings would not be organized into a database.
- sighting** (noun): when you see a UFO
e.g. Of course, I regret to say that not all sightings are taken seriously.
- authorities** (noun): people or organizations with power
e.g. Were it not for us, the authorities would be fielding a lot of calls from citizens.
- extraterrestrial** (noun): coming from outside planet Earth
e.g. The government has already invested millions of dollars in research on extraterrestrial life.





Learning Points

The Unreal Conditional: Expressing Causal Connections

You use the Unreal Conditional to express a relationship between a cause and an effect in a hypothetical way.

You use *if it was not for* + *noun phrase* to say that one situation depends on another situation or person to come true. You use *If it weren't for ...* if you want to express yourself more formally.

Example:

If it weren't for overzealous reporters making fun of stories, more people wouldn't be worrying about telling them.

If you want to make a causal connection to a past situation, you can use *If it had not / hadn't been for* + *noun phrase*.

Example:

If it hadn't been for the people who helped him, he would sitting there in a daze.

In a formal context you can use *Had it not been ...* or *Were it not for ...*

Example:

Were it not for us, the authorities would be fielding a lot of calls from citizens.

Examples:

- *If it hadn't been for the people who helped him, he would sitting there in a daze.*
- *If it weren't for overzealous reporters making fun of stories, more people wouldn't be worrying about telling them.*
- *Were it not for our organization, sightings would not be organized into a database.*
- *Were it not for us, the authorities would be fielding a lot of calls from citizens.*
- *Had it not been for us, many could end up in hospitals or psychiatric facilities.*





Learning Points

Differences Between -ing and To-Infinitive

When you talk about two actions linked together, you normally use two verbs. The first verb follows the rules of conjugation for the sentence, while the second verb can be a verb in the -ing form or to+Infinitive

You can use two verbs to talk about two connected actions. The main verb introduces the main action, and the second verb in the -ing form gives more information about that action.

Structure:

Subject + first verb + -ing form of the second verb / to+ Infinitive

Verbs followed by -ing are *imagine, enjoy, consider, mind, keep, love/hate*.

Verbs followed by to+Infinitive are *ask, promise, agree, expect*.

Some verbs can be followed by either an -ing verb or to+Infinitive, like *like, love, hate, dislike, intend, dread, advise, recommend, regret ...*

The difference in meaning depends on the preceding verb.

Forget/Remember with to+Infinitive are looking forward into a future situation. With an -ing form they refer to a past action.

Advise/Recommend with to+Infinitive are followed by an object. With an -ing form there is no object.

Regret with to+Infinitive is a polite form of apology. With an -ing form it has the meaning of *If only this hadn't happened*.

Look at some examples from the text:

Examples:

- *We advise callers to tell us exactly what happened.*
- *We advise having privacy when you call as well.*
- *I also recommend everyone to write down everything before they call.*
- *If you have seen an UFO I recommend calling us.*
- *Of course, I regret to say that not all sightings are taken seriously.*
- *They may regret me telling you this, but it's true.*

